

Getting gas

Gas is only found in certain places. To get it to where it is needed, it is fed through very long pipes, or changed into liquid and put in special ships.



Glass bottles are shaped from molten glass.

Making glass

Glass is made by melting together sand, soda ash, and ground limestone. People blow or machine-press the red-hot mineral mixture into different shapes. These set hard and clear as the glass cools.

Extracting metals

Most metals are found underground as minerals in rocks called ores. Giant machines dig up the ore. The metal is extracted, or taken out, from the ore using heat.



Metal variety

Different metal resources have different uses.



Aluminum is a soft metal used to make cans, aircraft, and car bodies.



Gold is rare and looks beautiful, so it is often used to make awards and medals.



Iron is strong. It is used to make steel for ships, buildings, and towers.



Copper prevents barnacles from growing on it, so parts of ships are often coated with it.

Creating concrete

Concrete is an important building material. It is made with water, sand, gravel, and cement. Water, sand, and gravel are found in the ground, while cement is made from limestone, which is also found in the ground.

